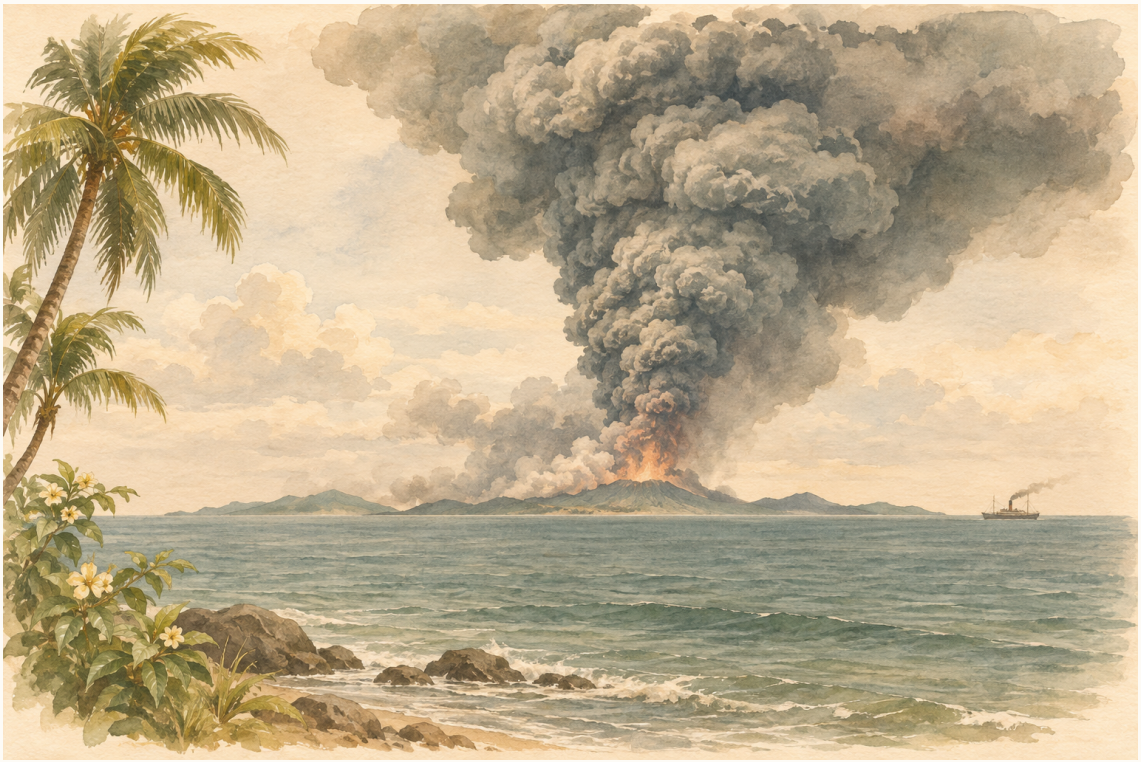
震动世界的一声巨响

The Sound That Shook the World



火山的一声巨响，如何传遍世界？

英文原文

Shortly after ten in the morning on 27 August 1883, Krakatoa, a **volcanic** island in the Sunda **Strait**, **unleashed** its most **thunderous** explosion. About four hours later, **islanders** on Rodrigues, nearly 4,800 kilometres across the Indian Ocean, took the **roar** for **distant gunfire**. **Barometers** worldwide recorded the **atmospheric** pressure wave, some of them seven times in about five days.

Restless since 20 May, the volcano reached a **catastrophic climax** on 26–27 August. About two-thirds of the island **collapsed into** its **emptied magma** chamber, **vanishing** beneath the sea. **Tsunamis**, **reportedly** over 30 metres high in places, **swamped coastal settlements** on Java and Sumatra. Dutch **colonial administrators** counted 36,417 dead, mostly **drowned**, perhaps **underestimating** the **toll**.

Telegrams from Batavia (now Jakarta), **relayed** by **submarine cable**, reached London within hours. Western newspapers soon began **chronicling** what is often called the first global news event. Yet early **dispatches** were **terse**; the **magnitude** of the **devastation** emerged **piecemeal** over days.

Ash and **sulphur** dioxide, **hurled** tens of kilometres high, formed a **haze** that circled the **equator** in about two weeks. In November 1883, **crimson** sunsets **glowed** over Europe and North America, **summoning firefighters** in New York and Connecticut to **phantom blazes**. Later climate **reconstructions** suggest global temperatures **dipped** a few tenths of a degree the following year.

英文原文（续）

Some experts **discounted** the volcanic explanation, blaming the **sunsets** on **moisture at high altitude** or **cosmic** dust. In February 1884, Britain's **Royal Society appealed** in The Times for dated observations, **eliciting** worldwide replies; the Society's 1888 report **tied** the glow **to** Krakatoa. Through barometers, cables, and crimson skies, **far-flung observers** began to **glimpse** how **interconnected** the planet already was.

中文译文

1883年8月27日上午10时刚过，喀拉喀托，一座位于巽他海峡的火山岛，迸发出其最为震耳欲聋的一声爆炸。约四小时后，罗德里格斯岛上的岛民，离着将近4800公里，远隔着一个印度洋，把这声轰鸣当成了远处的炮火声。世界各地的气压计都记录到了这次大气压力波，其中一些在大约五天之内记录到七次。

自5月20日起便躁动不安，这座火山达到灾难性的高潮是在8月26日至27日。约三分之二的岛体塌入已被排空的岩浆房，消失在海面之下。海啸据报道局部高逾30米，淹没了沿海居民点，遍及爪哇岛和苏门答腊岛。荷兰殖民地行政官员统计出36,417名死者，其中大多数是溺亡的，而他们或许低估了死亡人数。

电报从巴达维亚（今雅加达）发出，经海底电缆转发，在几小时内到达了伦敦。西方报纸很快便开始记述这起常被称为首个全球新闻事件的灾难。然而，早期的电讯都十分简短；浩劫的规模一点一点地显露出来，前后历经数日。

火山灰和二氧化硫被抛射到数十公里的高空，形成一层薄雾，在大约两个星期内环绕了赤道一周。1883年11月，深红色的晚霞发出暗淡的光，照耀着欧洲和北美，召唤着纽约州和康涅狄格州的消防员赶去扑救子虚乌有的大火。后来的气候重建研究推测，全球气温下降了零点几度，就在次年。

一些专家不予采信火山之说，而把晚霞归因于高空的水汽或宇宙尘埃。1884年2月，英国皇家学会发出呼吁，在《泰晤士报》上征集注明日期的观测记录，引起了世界各地的回应；学会1888年发表的报告把这片红霞归于喀拉喀托火山。借助气压计、电缆和深红色的天空，相隔遥远的观察者们开始认识到，这颗星球上的各个地方早已相互关联在一起。

词汇与表达

volcanic adj.
火山

Strait n.
海峡

unleashed v.
迸发出
unleashed its most thunderous

thunderous adj.
震耳欲聋的
its most thunderous explosion.

islanders n.
岛民

roar n.
轰鸣

distant adj.
远处的

gunfire n.
炮火声

Barometers n.
气压计
Barometers worldwide recorded the

atmospheric adj.
大气
the atmospheric pressure wave,

Restless adj.
躁动不安

catastrophic adj.
灾难性的
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

climax n.
高潮
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

collapsed into v.
塌入
the island collapsed into its emptied

emptied adj.
已被排空的

magma n.
岩浆

vanishing v.
消失

Tsunamis n.
海啸

reportedly adv.
据报道
Tsunamis, reportedly over 30 metres

swamped v.
淹没了
swamped coastal settlements on Java

词汇与表达（续）

coastal adj.
沿海

settlements n.
居民点

colonial adj.
殖民地

administrators n.
行政官员

drowned v.
溺亡

underestimating v.
低估了
perhaps underestimating the toll.

toll n.
死亡人数
perhaps underestimating the toll.

Telegrams n.
电报

relayed v.
转发
relayed by submarine cable,

submarine adj.
海底

cable n.
电缆

chronicling v.
记述

dispatches n.
电讯

terse adj.
简短
Yet early dispatches were terse;

magnitude n.
规模
the magnitude of the devastation

devastation n.
浩劫
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

piecemeal adv.
一点一点地
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

Ash n.
火山灰

sulphur n.
硫

hurled v.
抛射

haze n.
薄雾
haze that circled the equator in about

词汇与表达（续）

equator n.
赤道

crimson adj.
深红色的

glowed v.
发出暗淡的光

summoning v.
召唤着

firefighters n.
消防员

phantom adj.
子虚乌有的

blazes n.
大火

reconstructions n.
重建
Later climate reconstructions suggest

dipped v.
下降了

discounted v.
不予采信
Some experts discounted the volcanic

at high altitude n.
高空

sunsets n.
晚霞

moisture n.
水汽

cosmic adj.
宇宙

Royal Society n.
皇家学会

appealed v.
呼吁

eliciting v.
引起了
eliciting worldwide replies;

tied to v.
把……归于

far-flung adj.
相隔遥远的
far-flung observers began to glimpse

observers n.
观察者

glimpse v.
认识到

interconnected adj.
相互关联
how interconnected the planet already

文章简述

- 巨响：1883年喀拉喀托火山喷发，声传近4800公里；全球气压计录到压力波，有些约5天记录到它经过7次。
- 灾难：约三分之二岛体塌入地下原先储存岩浆、此时已排空的空间，并没入海中；海啸据报局部逾30米，官方记36417人死亡，多数溺亡，或仍低估。
- 快讯：海底电缆让电报数小时到伦敦，消息迅速传遍全球；但早期报道简短，灾情规模数日后才逐渐清楚。
- 余波：火山灰和二氧化硫形成高空薄雾，远方出现红霞；后人根据气候证据估算，1884年全球降温零点几度。
- 考证：当时有人把红霞归于高空水汽或宇宙尘埃；皇家学会汇集全球观测，1888年报告将红霞与喷发联系起来。